

Chapter 157-2: Ending (Part 1)

"Where else do you want to take me?" Ning Fuyi asked.

"There are still many places we haven't been to," Chu Qingqiu said softly.

Then they went to an immortal mountain called Zhaoyao Mountain¹, stepping into a high tower that had become ruins. The Xiangsi sword hummed here, and Chu Qingqiu told her this place was called Divine Fall.

They also went to a narrow, terrifying ravine, where it was said Jiuying had been rescued from. Ning Fuyi was extremely surprised.

There was also an immortal island full of cultivators, where a woman who greatly resembled Chu Qingqiu lived, a prosperous nation that had reportedly experienced earthquakes then been rebuilt with towering buildings, an unremarkable village, a filled cavern in the Eastern Wasteland...

Every place had its stories, and when those stories were narrated by Chu Qingqiu, Ning Fuyi could easily visualize the scenes.

As this happened more often, those images connected end to end, finally beginning to roll together coherently. Ning Fuyi became increasingly entranced, fascinated by those stories.

Finally, they came to a small town—a very, very small town. Outside the town were green grasses, distant mountains like brocade, and a river with rippling waves flowing from the mountains, winding through the grassland.

Chu Qingqiu's red robes trailed as she slowly walked on the green grass. Ning Fuyi followed her, and the two climbed up a hillside where many wildflowers grew beneath their feet—white and yellow blossoms swaying in the breeze.

Standing at the top of the hillside, a wooden house appeared before them. The house was quite old, with part of its outer courtyard wall already collapsed, moss growing abundantly inside, and the door left ajar as if someone had just been staying in the house.

Suddenly, an image flashed before Ning Fuyi's eyes: a woman in green robes pushed open the door, picked up a bamboo basket by the entrance and shouldered it, then silently walked down the hillside and disappeared into the green mountains.

More and more images connected, and Ning Fuyi gripped the Emei thorns at her fingertips. In her daze, the person beside her took her hand again, and then the scene changed.

They stood before three graves. The graves had been unattended for some time, but someone had placed a bundle of flowers in front of them. The flowers were dried but not yet rotten—they must have been placed recently.

The words on the tombstones had been weathered, but one could still make out what was written.

"My beloved, Su Mo." Ning Fuyi's steps faltered for a moment, and more memories surged from somewhere unknown, like a dam bursting. Ning Fuyi half-crouched down, her fingertips digging into the earth.

Chu Qingqiu felt great heartache. She bent down to embrace her, gently patting her back.

Experiences galloped like thousands of horses—from the moment of birth to death, then from rebirth to death again—frantically thundering through her mind with rumbling noise. Ning Fuyi held onto Chu Qingqiu like a lifeline, gritting her teeth and enduring.

Finally, the sound of hoofbeats stopped, and the images turned to warm orange. Sunlight passed through her eyelids and fell into her gaze.

She tremblingly opened her eyes, feeling as if she had just awakened from a great dream, unable to distinguish reality from chaos.

Chu Qingqiu didn't know whether she had remembered or not, so she continued to hold her, not daring to move or speak. After a moment, Ning Fuyi was the first to speak.

"I must go back and give Fengdu² a good beating. If only he had calculated earlier that my physical body wasn't dead, I wouldn't have had to taste that sip of Meng Po's soup³." She laughed weakly, covered in fine perspiration.

Upon hearing this, Chu Qingqiu froze, then suddenly let go and looked into those phoenix eyes: "You remember?"

Ning Fuyi was pushed so hard she nearly stumbled, but quickly steadied herself and shrugged with a smile: "No."

Chu Qingqiu's eyes widened slightly, then she reached to the side of her face, pinching her earlobe and lifting it up. Ning Fuyi cried out in pain: "It hurts, Chu Qingqiu, it hurts!"

Both joyful and angry, Chu Qingqiu didn't know how to punish her properly. After pinching her ear red, she went to pinch her face, finally bending down to bite hard at her shoulder, making Ning Fuyi yelp and cry out.

But she still couldn't bear to use force. After holding her clothes in her mouth for a while, tears began falling pitter-patter.

Ning Fuyi felt the wetness and pushed the person away from herself, rolling up her sleeves to wipe her tears, but the more she wiped, the more fell. So she smiled bitterly: "I remember, truly."

As soon as the words fell, the woman had embraced her again, the embrace so full that it couldn't contain even a flower's gap.

This was the first time Ning Fuyi heard the woman cry aloud, letting out low sobs, followed by another wet kiss. She had never seen Chu Qingqiu show such initiative in displaying affection, as if afraid she would leave again.

Chu Qingqiu kissed somewhat frantically, her white teeth repeatedly biting Ning Fuyi's lips, finally drawing thin traces of blood.

Chu Qingqiu turned and kissed all the tears into their lips. The sweet flower fragrance and salty tears mixed in their mouths into a fresh taste. Her hands clung to Ning Fuyi's shoulders, pushing her down into the fragrant grass.

Ning Fuyi neither struggled nor refused. She absorbed Chu Qingqiu's longing through the kisses, finally wrapping her arms around the woman's back and beginning to kiss back.

All words dissolved in this moment. Ning Fuyi kissed until both their eyes were full of tear tracks before she turned over and sat up. When she tried to pull Chu Qingqiu up, the other didn't rise.

Chu Qingqiu looked at her with slightly reddened eyes, saying nothing, yet seeming to say everything.

Her hands still gripped Ning Fuyi's sleeves. Her red robes looked even redder against the green grass, while her skin was white as skylight. There was no seduction in her eyes, but it drove one mad nonetheless.

So Ning Fuyi bent down and lifted her up. Black mist spread and dissipated, and they were already standing in the wooden house.

The house was fairly clean, just thick with dust, but after Ning Fuyi strode through, the wooden table and chairs became clean as new, everything restored to how it was five years ago.

Ning Fuyi placed her on the bed, but her sash was caught, pulling her entire body down in a stumbling fall. To avoid crushing the other person, she had to brace her hands on the bedside.

Chu Qingqiu lay flat beneath her, beautiful and cool as ever, but her eyes held something different beyond intoxication.

Then Ning Fuyi felt a coolness on her shoulder—somehow her outer robe had been undone. The cloud-silk fabric was lifted by those soft hands and thrown down, sliding along the bedside to the floor. Then the bed curtains also came loose, rustling down to block the setting sun.

Bare arms climbed up her neck, knotting behind her head, then arched upward. Breath brushed past her earlobe, making Ning Fuyi's whole body tremble. Then kisses fell on her ear, cheek, all the way to her lips.

"Ning Fuyi," Chu Qingqiu said, her voice like both command and sigh. "Ning Fuyi..."

Footnotes:

¹ **Zhaoyao Mountain** - A fictional immortal mountain in the story, likely significant to the protagonists' past

² **Fengdu** - In Chinese mythology, refers to the underworld or the King of Hell who oversees the realm of the dead

³ **Meng Po's soup** - In Chinese mythology, a soup that erases memories of past lives, drunk by souls before reincarnation